Information For the Use of
Apremilast (30mg) Tablets

Zaprem 30 Tablet

ZAPREM 30 TABLET

Apremilast 30 mg

Composition

Each tablet contains:

- **Apremilast – 30 mg**

Pharmacological Action

Apremilast is an orally active **phosphodiesterase-4 (PDE4) inhibitor**. By inhibiting PDE4, it increases intracellular cyclic AMP and modulates inflammatory signaling pathways, resulting in reduced production of several pro-inflammatory mediators.

It functions by:

- **PDE4 Inhibition:** Inhibits phosphodiesterase-4 and increases intracellular cyclic AMP.
- **Anti-inflammatory Action:** Modulates inflammatory mediator production involved in chronic inflammatory skin and joint disorders.
- **Immunomodulatory Action:** Helps regulate inflammatory responses without directly suppressing the immune system in the manner of conventional immunosuppressive agents.
- **Symptom Control:** Helps reduce the inflammatory manifestations associated with psoriasis and psoriatic arthritis.

Indications

Zaprem 30 Tablets are indicated for the management of:

- **Active psoriatic arthritis**
- **Moderate-to-severe plaque psoriasis** in patients who are candidates for phototherapy or systemic therapy
- **Oral ulcers associated with Behçet's disease** in adults

In India, CDSCO records also specifically reference approved **Apremilast 10/20/30 mg tablets** for active psoriatic arthritis.

Dosage and Administration

- **Recommended Dose:** Apremilast treatment is generally initiated using a **5-day dose-escalation schedule** to reduce gastrointestinal intolerance. The usual maintenance dose from Day 6 is **30 mg twice daily**, as directed by the physician.
- **Administration:** Tablets may be taken with or without food and should be swallowed whole with water.
- **Severe Renal Impairment:** In patients with severe renal impairment, the maintenance dose should be reduced to **30 mg once daily**, with appropriate adjustment of the initial titration schedule.
- **Duration of Use:** Continue treatment as prescribed by the healthcare provider.

Precautions

- **Pregnancy:** Use during pregnancy only when clearly considered necessary by the treating physician.
- **Lactation:** Consult a healthcare professional before use during breastfeeding.
- **Renal Impairment:** Dose adjustment is required in patients with severe renal impairment.
- **Weight Loss:** Monitor patients for clinically significant or unexplained weight loss during treatment.
- **Depression/Mood Changes:** Patients should be monitored for new or worsening depression, suicidal thoughts or other significant changes in mood.
- **Gastrointestinal Effects:** Diarrhoea, nausea and vomiting can occur, particularly during initiation of therapy.

Contraindications

- Known hypersensitivity to **apremilast** or any component of the formulation.
- Use during pregnancy should be avoided unless specifically determined appropriate by the treating physician.
- Appropriate medical evaluation is advised in patients with severe renal impairment before initiating treatment.

Adverse Reactions

Common:

- Diarrhoea
- Nausea
- Vomiting
- Headache
- Tension headache
- Upper respiratory tract infection
- Abdominal discomfort
- Decreased appetite

Rare but Serious:

- Significant weight loss
- Severe or persistent gastrointestinal symptoms
- Depression or suicidal ideation
- Serious hypersensitivity reactions

Patients should contact their healthcare provider if they experience significant mood changes, severe allergic symptoms, persistent vomiting/diarrhoea or substantial unexplained weight loss.

Drug Interactions

- **Strong CYP450 enzyme inducers:** Rifampicin, phenobarbital, carbamazepine, phenytoin and other strong CYP450 inducers may reduce apremilast exposure and decrease its therapeutic effectiveness.
- **Other medicines:** Inform the physician about all prescription, non-prescription and herbal medicines being used before starting treatment.
- No clinically significant interaction is expected with most conventional medicines, but concomitant therapy should be reviewed by the treating physician.

Storage

- Store in a **cool, dry place**, protected from excessive heat and moisture.
- Keep the tablets in their original packaging until use.
- Keep out of reach of children.

Note

This information is intended as a **professional pharmaceutical-literature guideline**. **Zaprem 30 should be used under the supervision of a qualified healthcare professional.** Apremilast therapy normally requires initial dose titration rather than starting directly with the 30 mg maintenance dose.

Manufactured in India for:

Cafoli™
LIFECARE

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